

hype thesis

Simputer

▲ What is it?

This is a simple low cost mobile computer that has a 320x240 screen, 32 MB RAM and runs on Linux. Input options include a screen-based keyboard, a graffiti-style software and the Information Markup Language (IML) that is (amongst other things) smart-card aware and XML-based.

▲ What's so great about it?

It aims to lower the cost barrier for people who would otherwise never be able to afford access to computers.

▲ Who made it?

It is currently under development by the Simputer Trust and will be licensed to manufacturers to produce under their own Simputer GPL. Find them at: www.simputer.org

AMD Going 4 Mobile

Early reports on AMD's latest processor (code-named Palomino) are out. This processor, which has a 37-million transistor core, will be called the Athlon 4 and marks AMD's first serious performance product for mobile computing products.



Athlon 4 will initially come in four speeds: 850 MHz, 900 MHz, 950 MHz and 1 GHz for mobile computers.

According to AMD, Compaq will probably become the first PC manufacturer to offer the Athlon 4, in its Presario

notebook.

The mobile version of the Athlon 4 will feature AMD's PowerNow! technology, which allows the processor to dynamically change its clock speed and operating voltage depending on the applications and demands on the CPU. The 1 GHz Athlon 4 will make use of the PowerNow! technology to scale from 500 MHz to 1 GHz and run at voltages of 1.2 V to 1.4 V.

This technology is AMD's answer to Intel's SpeedStep technology, which made the Pentium III processors extremely popular with laptop and notebook manufacturers.

Also being launched is the mobile Duron, which is based on the Morgan core. This will constitute AMD's value solution for mobile computers. The desktop version of the Athlon 4 is expected go up against the Pentium 4 sometime later this year.

Beat the Heat, Digitally!

Carrier, a provider of heating, ventilating and refrigeration systems, has struck a deal with IBM to install Java-enabled chips into Carrier air-conditioners, which will enable the owners to remotely set the temperature and switch on or off the cooling devices. IBM will service the chip and software within the unit.

The system is designed with the embedded Java serving up the site to any mobile or desktop device via GSM mobile wireless networks. So if you're a Carrier AC owner, you can access the company's site, Myappliance.com, and pay a fee to check your unit on the Web.

Alternatively, fault codes and diagnostic alerts can be sent directly from the AC to the service technicians via e-mail or fax; they can check your unit on the Web site and tell you what the problem is.

Microsoft XP: Building another monopoly?

SNAPSHOT

The first computer bug discovered by Admiral Grace Hopper, was a moth caught in the computer relay switch, causing errors!

Damage worth millions of pounds caused as more than 12,000 Dell computers affected by the Funlove virus

Source: Data Fellows, www.cs.yale.edu

Is XP the latest bully on the block? It doesn't seem so at first glance. Microsoft's upcoming operating system will provide users with an Internet chat program, a new security program, a DVD player and software to burn personal CDs. MSN Messenger will install and load automatically every time XP is run.

But this has led to complaints alleging that Microsoft is using the same product-bundling strategy that had given rise to the antitrust case involving the company's anti-competitive practices such as bundling the Internet Explorer browser with the Windows 98 OS.

Microsoft counters that it is simply trying to improve its product with new features that consumers demand, and that its rivals are trying to do the same thing: expand into new markets.

Companies like Symantec and RealNetworks, which make software that might be affected by this product bundling, claim that the new Microsoft applications are rudimentary and not the best in their categories.

Microsoft's view is that if people don't find the new features in XP compelling enough to upgrade, they can choose not to.

